

Grade 2 RS Master Manual

CHAPTER 1: FOUNDATIONS

"Education is not the filling of a pail, but the lighting of a fire."

— W.B. Yeats

What is "RS" in Grade 2?

RS (Reading Strategies) is the engine room of your English Language Arts block. It is where students learn how to unlock text, build vocabulary, master spelling, and think critically. Your students are EFL learners. They do not live in an English-immersion environment outside your classroom. For an I-Group student, English is a code they are still trying to crack. For an A-Group student, they can decode the words, but they often miss the deeper meaning, idioms, and nuances.

RS isn't just about reading a story; it is about building the linguistic scaffolding they need to survive and thrive academically. You aren't just teaching what a story says; you are teaching them *how* to read so they can eventually read to learn.

The 6 Weekly RS Periods

Your 6 weekly RS periods (structured as three 80-minute blocks on Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday) are multi-tasking powerhouses. You are responsible for teaching:

- **Reading Comprehension & Strategies:** Using HMH Anchor Charts and *myBook* stories to teach how to think about text (e.g., Central Idea, Ask & Answer, Character Traits).
- **Vocabulary Acquisition:** Explicitly teaching Power Words so students can master them for their RS Tests and Midterm Exams.
- **Phonics & Spelling:** Managing the Spelling Workbook, high-frequency words, and spelling tests.
- **Grammar:** Integrating grammar mechanics from the Grammar Practice Book and Course Pack.

CHAPTER 2: METHODOLOGY

"In learning you will teach, and in teaching you will learn."

—Phil Collins

The *myBook* 5-Step Instructional Framework

The *myBook* stories are rich, complex, grade-level anchor texts. They are not leveled decodable readers, which means you cannot throw students into them cold. To teach them effectively, use this 5-step framework:

Step 1: The Picture Walk (Building Background Knowledge)

WHY

For EFL learners, jumping straight into a high-Lexile text is like walking into a movie halfway through without subtitles. Pictures pre-load context and lower anxiety.

A- GROUP

Strategy: Ask predictive questions: *"Look at his face on page 12. What do you think he will do next?"*

I- GROUP

Strategy: Ask identifying questions: *"Point to the dog. What color is the house?"*

Step 2: Teacher Read-Aloud (Modeling)

Read the text clearly with rich expression. This models proper pacing, pronunciation, and intonation for your EFL learners.

Step 3: Power Words (Active Vocabulary Instruction)

Explicitly teach the vocabulary words before deep-diving into the text's meaning.

Step 4: Close Reading (Digging for Meaning)

Guide the students back through the text to analyze the reading strategy objective.

Step 5: Shared Reading Practice (Fluency Exposure)

WHY

Traditional round-robin reading causes panic. Shared Reading gives every student mass speaking reps in a low-stakes group environment.

A- GROUP

Strategy: Use Choral Reading or "Ping-Pong Reading" (Boys read a sentence, girls read the next).

I- GROUP

Strategy: Strictly use Echo Reading for complex sentences. Teacher reads; class echoes perfectly. Use Cloze Reading Drop-Ins on sight words: "*The dog ran into the...*" (Class shouts: "*HOUSE!*").

TIP

Stop & Go: Read chorally, but when you hold up a red hand, everyone must freeze instantly. Use proximity control or sudden dramatic whispers to snap wandering attention back to the text.

CHAPTER 3: SCHEDULING & LOGISTICS

"By failing to prepare, you are preparing to fail."

— Benjamin Franklin

Surviving the "Lost Block" Reality

Holidays, sports days, typhoons, and field trips will inevitably wipe out an entire 2-period block at some point. When your schedule gets compressed, follow these golden rules:

1. **Never cut Steps 1 and 2.** If you skip the Picture Walk and Read-Aloud, your EFL students cannot close-read a text they have never heard.
2. **Compress, Don't Skip.** Combine Step 3 (Power Words) and Step 4 (Close Reading) into a single fast-paced 40-minute push.
3. **Drop Formal Shared Reading (Step 5).** If time is critical, do 5 minutes of rapid echo reading, administer your spelling test, and move forward.